

4. Academic, Wellbeing and Social Support

If you have any queries relating to your studies or there are personal circumstances that you feel will impact your performance, there are numerous sources of support. These include:



- Your Personal Tutor - You will be allocated a Personal Tutor at the start of your programme
- Welfare Officers - The Computer Science Welfare Team are contactable via the [EPS Wellbeing Canvas page](#).
- Senior Tutor - The Senior Tutors in the School of Computer Science oversee pastoral support and the link with academic performance. The Senior Tutors are Todd Waugh Ambridge (t.waughambridge@bham.ac.uk) and Ian Batten (i.g.batten@bham.ac.uk).

The sources of support listed above can provide you with guidance on topics such as Leave of Absence, Extenuating Circumstances, Reasonable Adjustments, etc. or will be able to point you in the right direction.

Expand all

Personal Academic Tutor



All students on programmes administered by the School of Computer Science are assigned a Personal Tutor.

Your Personal Tutor will be a member of academic staff with whom you can discuss any academic or pastoral issues. Your Personal Tutor will discuss progress, feedback on assessments, employability and personal development. They can also offer advice on module choices, options for placement and study abroad opportunities.

Your Personal Tutor will be able to give help and advice, but, in cases where this is not possible, your Personal Tutor will be able to direct you to the appropriate resources and sources of support.

If you wish to meet your Personal Tutor, we advise attending their office hour or sending them an email in the first instance. [\[link\]](#)

Here is a collection of Frequently Asked Questions about Personal Tutoring, including how to find out who your tutor is [\[link\]](#).

Your Wellbeing



There is a wide range of support available to help you take care of your physical and mental wellbeing. Support available includes self-help guides, drop-in services, and, where appropriate, specialised support.

Your Wellbeing: <https://intranet.birmingham.ac.uk/student/Your-Wellbeing>



Wellbeing Officers



The School of Computer Science Wellbeing Officers who are able to provide support if you are experiencing personal problems, particularly where these might interfere with your study. They can recommend sources of professional help and, if appropriate, will guide you through the extenuating circumstances process.

If you are experiencing personal difficulties, please contact the Wellbeing Team. You do not need to tell your module organisers or Personal Tutor before contacting the Wellbeing Team. Wellbeing Officers will never share details of your situation or any other personal information without your consent.

You MUST inform the Wellbeing team if any special circumstances occur which might affect your ability to study. If you do not then it may be difficult to take these circumstances into account when confirming your academic performance, e.g., at exam boards.

Student Support Hub: <https://intranet.birmingham.ac.uk/student/student-hub/hub-services.aspx#ss>

Contacting the Wellbeing Team

You can contact the Wellbeing Officers directly via cswelfare@contacts.bham.ac.uk. As well as providing another ways to get in touch, the Wellbeing Canvas page contains information, support and guidance, and announcements relating to drop-in times.

Wellbeing Canvas Page: [EPS Wellbeing](#)

Requesting an Appointment with a Wellbeing Officer

Wellbeing Officers have a limited number of video appointments to offer each week. On the submission of this form your request will be triaged by the College Wellbeing Team. This may result in you being offered an email consultation rather than a video appointment.

This can be reviewed at a later date if your circumstances change.

If you are offered an appointment you will be invited to speak with your Wellbeing Officer in a Zoom meeting, the link and password will be provided by email. These meetings will be confidential and you can choose whether you want to enable your video or not.

Request A Wellbeing Appointment:

<https://outlook.office.com/book/EPSCComputerScienceWellbeingAppointmentBookingForm@bookings.bham.ac.uk/?ismsaljsauthenabaled=true> ➞

Find Your Wellbeing Officers: <https://intranet.birmingham.ac.uk/student/Your-Wellbeing/wellbeing-officers.aspx> ➞

Student Privacy Notice: <https://www.birmingham.ac.uk/privacy/students.aspx> ➞



Report + Support



If you've been subjected to any form of harmful behaviour (for example: sexual violence; harassment; domestic abuse; hate; stalking; discrimination; bullying), then we're here to support you.

The University has a team of specially trained Responders who will provide a tailored service outlining the support and reporting options available. They will tailor the support to your needs and will offer a safe space for you to explore all your options, empowering you to make an informed decision about what to do next. You can request support by completing our [online form](#) ➞ which can be accessed at any time; you can also report anonymously.

The University of Birmingham is committed to providing person-centred support for all students and staff making a disclosure through our Report + Support tool. We can help support you, whatever you decide to do, and for as long as you need us.

Student Disability Service (Support for Disabled, Neurodiverse and/or Chronically-ill Students)



The Student Disability Service can arrange course and study-related reasonable adjustments and additional academic-related support for students with a disability, including long-term mental or physical health conditions, autistic spectrum conditions and specific learning difficulties. The Student Disability Service can also provide advice and support for students applying for the Disabled Students' Allowance (DSA).

If you have a disability, are neurodiverse and/or have a long-term/chronic health condition, and you have not already registered with the Student Disability Service, it is advisable to do so as soon as possible in order to access the full range of support available to you.

Student Disability: <https://intranet.birmingham.ac.uk/student/Your-Wellbeing/disability> ➞

Neurodiverse students may find the Main Library's bookable **Assistive Technology Booths** ➞ useful for studying.



Student Help and Aston Webb Student Hub



The Student Help Knowledge Base on the Student Hub provides answers to hundreds of frequently asked questions.

The Aston Webb Student Hub is located in the Aston Webb Building, at the centre of campus. You can visit the Hub Services Information team to ask them your queries, make a request for help / support, or, where necessary, access specialist support.

Student Hub: <https://intranet.birmingham.ac.uk/student/student-hub>

Academic Skills Centre and Study Support



The Academic Skills Centre (ASC) is a part of Library Services. It supports taught students to become more effective learners and communicators.

The ASC can help develop:

- Academic writing
- Digital skills
- Confidence in mathematics and statistics
- Research and information skills
- Referencing, time management, critical thinking and revision

Academic Skills Centre: <https://intranet.birmingham.ac.uk/as/libraryservices/asc> ➞

Peer Assisted Study Sessions (PASS)

The University of Birmingham Peer Assisted Study Sessions (PASS) scheme is a peer support project overseen by Library Services. The PASS scheme involves higher year students helping first-year students with their study across an academic module. It is successful because it is discipline-owned and student-led. PASS is part of a recognised National and International network.

Peer Assisted Study Sessions: <https://intranet.birmingham.ac.uk/as/libraryservices/pass> 

Academic English Language and Skills Support

The Birmingham International Academy's (BIA) **Academic English Programme** provides Academic English language and skills development free of charge to all international students currently studying at the University of Birmingham whose first language is not English.

Fluency and accuracy in English are key for academic interaction and engagement, completion of assessments, social communication, networking and employability. The BIA offer a range of flexible learning opportunities all year round, to develop skills and confidence in academic English.

To find out more about the Academic English Programme visit the:

- Web page: [BIA Academic English homepage](#) 
- Self-enrolment Canvas course: [BIA Academic English Canvas Course](#).

Alternatively, you can contact: bia@contacts.bham.ac.uk.

Medical

Staying healthy at University will help you make the most of your time here. Students are strongly encouraged to register with a local Doctor / GP (General Practitioner) so that you are able to access healthcare when you need to. There are a number of GP practices local to the University. You can use the [NHS Service Search website](#)  to find which options are suitable for you.

Outbreaks of vaccine-preventable infections can sometimes happen at universities because of shared living and varied friendship groups. The University works with health partners to quickly contain any infectious illness, and inform staff and students who may be at risk. Visit the **Preventing Infectious Diseases Intranet page**  to find out more about how to prevent the spread of infection and common symptoms.



International Student Team

The International Student Team (IST) provides support and advice for prospective and current international students on immigration, visas, and adapting to life at the University.

Find out more on the **IST Intranet page** .

Guild of Students

As a University of Birmingham student you are automatically a member of the Guild of Students. The Guild is there to represent you, support you, keep you entertained and ensure you make the most of university life. Further information about the Guild of Students can be found in the **Student Representation** section of the Student Handbook.

Departmental Societies

The University of Birmingham is home to hundreds of student groups and societies. Some societies enjoy a special relationship with the School of Computer Science, due to shared interests and long-standing engagements.

Student Groups and Societies: <https://www.birmingham.ac.uk/welcome/events/societies.aspx> 

Computer Science Society (CSS)

The society for Computer Science is called CSS. They work to make sure to create events and provide a medium through which computer scientists can meet, make friends, and partake in a whole lot of exciting activities. Visit their website [here](#).

CSS: <https://cssbham.com> ➞

A Finite Number of Monkeys (AFNOM)

AFNOM are the Hacking Club at the University of Birmingham. They get together every week to look at offensive hacking and cyber security. They do this because understanding threats and how attackers think is the best way to keep computers secure, plus it's very fun.

AFNOM: <https://afnom.net> ➞

Games Development Society (GDS)

Games Development Society is for anyone who enjoys creating video games. They help everyone learn more about video game development, offer opportunities to express creativity through programming or even art and music.

GDS: <https://www.facebook.com/groups/289732777813843> ➞

Women in Science and Engineering (WiSE)

WiSE is a non-profit, student-led organisation with the aim of supporting and promoting women within STEM (Science, Technology, Engineering and Mathematics) . They welcome undergraduates and postgraduates from all STEM backgrounds and organise a range of events including socials, industrial visits, talks and outreach activities.

WiSE: <https://wiseuob.com> ➞

Finance and Fees



For information about paying your student fees for tuition or accommodation, visit the [**Student Fees**](#) ➞ Intranet page.

The Funding, Graduation & Awards team provide financial advice and support, and can help with any funding applications throughout your studies. Find out more on the [**Financial Support Intranet page**](#) ➞.

Careers Network



As a student at the University you have access to our expert careers support and a wide range of services to help you take that next step towards employment. You can obtain careers advice information from Careers Network, which offers face-to-face advice and guidance appointments. Students can submit careers-related queries including requests for general careers advice, CV and application form advice, and general information. Your College team will provide specialist advice for your subject areas. Find out more about Careers Network and your College team on the [**Careers Network Intranet page**](#) ➞.

The Birmingham Award is the University's recognised free employability skills award for undergraduate students. Endorsed by graduate employers, the award supports you to develop and recognise the skills you gain through extra-curricular activities – there are over 200 activities you can recognise! Find out more on the [**Birmingham Award Intranet Page**](#) ➞.

Multi-Faith Chaplaincy



The Multi-Faith Chaplaincy offers an inclusive space for prayer, meditation, relaxation and worship, among many other activities. All students are welcome to visit, it does not matter if you are religious or not.

Located at St Francis Hall, adjacent to the Guild of Students, the Multi-Faith Chaplaincy also supports a number of student faith groups and has chaplains and faith leaders from several different religions for you to talk to.

Multi-Faith Chaplaincy: [**https://intranet.birmingham.ac.uk/student/multi-faith-chaplaincy**](https://intranet.birmingham.ac.uk/student/multi-faith-chaplaincy) ➞

